underneath the surface of the ground. We could not go far, as deep digging and archaeological explorations were not approved by authority, nor did we have the wherewithal to carry this on. O n c e we came across a lovely lotus carved in stone on the side of a wall, probably over a doorway.

I remembered another a n d a less h a p p y discovery in Dehra D u n Jail. In the course of digging in my little yard, three years ago, I came across a curious relic of past days. Deep under the surface of the ground, the remains of two ancient piles were uncovered a n d we viewed them with some excitement. They were part of the old gallows that h a d functioned there thirty or forty years earlier. T h e jail had long ceased to be a place of execution a n d all visible signs of the old gallows-tree had been removed. We h a d discovered a n d uprooted its foundations, a n d all my fellow-prisoners, w h o h a d helped in this process, rejoiced that we h a d p u t away at last this thing of ill omen.

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Now I have put away my spade and taken to the pen instead. Possibly what I write now will meet the same fate as my unfinished manuscript of Dehra Dun Jail. I cannot write about the